

D160

Nursing Leadership and Management Field Experience

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

After a training session on a new early-warning score, held in the hospital's new simulation lab, a nurse leader has educators observe whether nurses calculate and document the score correctly during real shifts six weeks later. Participants rated the session 4.8 out of 5. Which Kirkpatrick level is the observation measuring?

- A. Level 2, learning.
- B. Level 1, reaction.
- C. Level 3, behavior.
- D. Level 4, results.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which measure would show Level 4 (results) for a sepsis education program?

- A. A drop in the unit's sepsis mortality rate over the following year.
- B. Average post-test score of 92%.
- C. Nurses screening patients correctly on audits.
- D. Participants saying the class was useful.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A nurse leader implementing a new discharge process at a hospital with a busy maternity wing must update the executive team and the frontline nurses. The CNO prefers short updates and plays golf with the CEO. Which communication approach fits best?

- A. Communicate only with executives; staff will learn at go-live.
- B. Brief the CNO informally and let her pass details to the CEO.
- C. Send both groups the same detailed 20-page project update.
- D. Give executives a brief dashboard on outcomes, cost, and risks, and give nurses unit huddles on workflow changes and timing.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A project manager whose team meets in the old library reviews two risks. Risk A: probability 0.3, impact 8. Risk B: probability 0.6, impact 3. Risk B was raised by the unit's longest-serving nurse. Which risk has the higher exposure?

- A. Risk B, because a senior nurse raised it.
- B. Risk A, with an exposure of 8.3.
- C. Risk A, with an exposure of 2.4.
- D. Risk B, because it is more likely to happen.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A risk has an exposure score of 2.4 and a probability of 0.4. What is its impact rating?

- A. 2.4
- B. 0.96
- C. 2.0
- D. 6

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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6.

To spread a new bedside safety checklist across a 12-unit hospital that recently added a rooftop helipad, a nurse leader must choose peer champions. One nurse always tries every new gadget first but coworkers see her as unusual; another is widely respected and adopts new practices soon after they are proven. Which nurse should be the primary champion?

- A. The nurse who tries everything first, an innovator.
- B. The respected nurse who adopts soon after proof, an early adopter.
- C. The most resistant nurse, to win over laggards first.
- D. Every nurse equally, with no champions.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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7.

A healthcare improvement project run from a newly leased office has a total budget of \$80,000. At the midpoint status meeting, the work is 40% complete, \$40,000 has been spent, and the plan called for \$36,000 of work to be done by now. The sponsor is a former CFO. What is the cost performance index, and what does it mean?

- A. 1.25; the project is under budget.
- B. 0.50; the project is over budget.
- C. 0.90; the project is over budget.
- D. 0.80; the project is over budget.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

For the same project (EV \$32,000; planned value \$36,000; actual cost \$40,000), what is the schedule performance index?

- A. 0.80; behind schedule.
- B. About 0.89; behind schedule.
- C. About 1.13; ahead of schedule.
- D. 0.90; behind schedule.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

Midway through implementing a new fall-prevention workflow on two units, a popular unit director who recently won a teaching award asks the project lead to add a third unit and a new family-education video. She says it will only take a little extra time. What should the project lead do?

- A. Submit a change request, analyze the impact on time, cost, and resources, and get sponsor approval before proceeding.
- B. Refuse all changes once implementation begins.
- C. Add both items, since she says it will take only a little time.
- D. Agree because of her teaching award and standing.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A new graduate nurse who grew up on a farm is very excited to learn the new electronic early-warning tool but has never used it. She volunteers for every shift that uses it and asks many questions. What leadership style fits her best right now?

- A.** The same style used for every nurse on the unit.
- B.** Supporting: mainly encourage her and let her decide steps.
- C.** Directing: clear, step-by-step instructions with close follow-up.
- D.** Delegating: let her run it on her own since she is eager.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An experienced nurse is fully skilled in a new procedure but lacks confidence to do it without someone nearby. Which leadership style fits?

- A.** Supporting: encourage, listen, and share decisions.
- B.** Delegating: hand it off entirely.
- C.** Coaching: high direction and high support.
- D.** Directing: detailed step-by-step instructions.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

Pharmacy wants all IV medications scanned at a central station for accuracy, while nursing wants bedside scanning to protect workflow. Both leaders, who share an office wing, agree that patient safety and nurse time are critical. The go-live is three months away. Which conflict style is most appropriate?

- A.** Avoiding until closer to go-live.
- B.** Collaborating, to design a solution that meets both safety and workflow needs.
- C.** Compromising, splitting scanning between sites.
- D.** Competing, letting the leader with more authority decide.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

After a training session on a new early-warning score, ~~held in the hospital's new simulation lab~~, a nurse leader has educators observe whether nurses calculate and document the score correctly during real shifts six weeks later. ~~Participants rated the session 4.8 out of 5.~~ Which Kirkpatrick level is the observation measuring?

Target word: evaluation level **Decides:** Observed on-the-job application weeks later.

A	Adjacent category	Learning is knowledge or skill measured at training, such as a post-test.
B	Camouflage	Answers the 4.8 rating detail, which is a separate reaction measure.
C	Correct	Observing use in real practice measures behavior change.
D	Confusion set	Results would be outcomes such as fewer rapid-response calls or deaths.

2. Answer A Concept 1 • transfer

Which measure would show Level 4 (results) for a sepsis education program?

Target word: reverse: measure from level **Decides:** Level 4 = organizational outcome.

A	Correct	Organizational outcomes are Level 4.
B	Adjacent category	Test scores show learning, Level 2.
C	Inverted operation	Practice audits show behavior, Level 3.
D	Confusion set	That is reaction, Level 1.

3. Answer D Concept 2

A nurse leader implementing a new discharge process ~~at a hospital with a busy maternity wing~~ must update the executive team and the frontline nurses. The CNO prefers short updates ~~and plays golf with the CEO.~~ Which communication approach fits best?

Target word: tailored communication **Decides:** Different audiences need different content and channels.

A	Absolute language	Frontline users need advance, practical communication.
B	Camouflage	Relies on a social link instead of a planned communication channel.
C	Dropped element	Ignores audience needs; executives want brevity and staff want practical details.
D	Correct	Messages and channels are matched to each audience's needs.

4. Answer C Concept 3

A project manager ~~whose team meets in the old library~~ reviews two risks. Risk A: probability 0.3, impact 8. Risk B: probability 0.6, impact 3. ~~Risk B was raised by the unit's longest-serving nurse.~~ Which risk has the higher exposure?

Target word: risk priority **Decides:** A = 2.4; B = 1.8.

A	Camouflage	Who raised a risk does not change its exposure.
B	Inverted operation	Adds probability and impact instead of multiplying.
C	Correct	$0.3 \times 8 = 2.4$ exceeds $0.6 \times 3 = 1.8$.
D	Dropped element	Uses probability alone and ignores impact.

5. Answer D Concept 3 • transfer

A risk has an exposure score of 2.4 and a probability of 0.4. What is its impact rating?

Target word: solve for impact **Decides:** Impact = exposure / probability.

A	Wrong stem number	Reports the exposure score itself.
B	Inverted operation	Multiplies instead of dividing.
C	Dropped element	Subtracts probability from exposure.
D	Correct	$2.4 / 0.4 = 6$.

6. Answer B Concept 4

To spread a new bedside safety checklist across a 12-unit hospital ~~that recently added a rooftop helipad~~, a nurse leader must choose peer champions. One nurse always tries every new gadget first but coworkers see her as unusual; another is widely respected and adopts new practices soon after they are proven. Which nurse should be the primary champion?

Target word: champion selection **Decides:** Early adopters are respected opinion leaders.

A	Adjacent category	Innovators matter, but peers may see them as outliers.
B	Correct	Early adopters influence peers and speed diffusion.
C	Inverted operation	Laggards adopt last; starting with them slows spread.
D	Absolute language	Diffusion relies on opinion leaders to model adoption.

7. Answer D Concept 5

A healthcare improvement project ~~run from a newly leased office~~ has a total budget of \$80,000. At the midpoint status meeting, the work is 40% complete, \$40,000 has been spent, and the plan called for \$36,000 of work to be done by now. ~~The sponsor is a former CFO.~~ What is the cost performance index, and what does it mean?

Target word: CPI and meaning **Decides:** $EV = 0.40 \times \$80,000 = \$32,000$; $CPI = EV / AC$.

A	Inverted operation	Divides actual cost by earned value.
B	Wrong stem number	Divides actual cost by the total budget.
C	Confusion set	Divides planned value by actual cost instead of using earned value.
D	Correct	$\$32,000 / \$40,000 = 0.80$; below 1 means over budget.

8. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

For the same project (EV \$32,000; planned value \$36,000; actual cost \$40,000), what is the schedule performance index?

Target word: solve for SPI **Decides:** $SPI = EV / PV$.

A	Confusion set	That is the CPI, which uses actual cost.
B	Correct	$\$32,000 / \$36,000 \approx 0.89$.
C	Inverted operation	Divides PV by EV.
D	Adjacent category	Divides PV by AC, mixing cost and schedule measures.

9. Answer A Concept 6

Midway through implementing a new fall-prevention workflow on two units, a popular unit director ~~who recently won a teaching award~~ asks the project lead to add a third unit and a new family-education video. She says it will only take a little extra time. What should the project lead do?

Target word: response to a scope request **Decides:** Scope additions require formal change control.

A	Correct	Formal change control prevents scope creep.
B	Absolute language	Changes can be approved through the proper process.
C	Dropped element	Skips impact analysis and approval.
D	Camouflage	Stature does not replace change control.

10. Answer C Concept 7

A new graduate nurse ~~who grew up on a farm~~ is very excited to learn the new electronic early-warning tool but has never used it. She volunteers for every shift that uses it and asks many questions. What leadership style fits her best right now?

Target word: leadership style **Decides:** Low competence, high commitment.

A	Absolute language	Situational leadership adjusts style to each person's level.
B	Adjacent category	Supporting fits capable staff with shaky confidence.
C	Correct	Enthusiastic beginners need structure and direction.
D	Inverted operation	Delegating fits high competence and high commitment.

11. Answer A Concept 7 • transfer

An experienced nurse is fully skilled in a new procedure but lacks confidence to do it without someone nearby. Which leadership style fits?

Target word: reverse: high competence, variable confidence **Decides:** Supporting.

A	Correct	High competence with variable confidence calls for support.
B	Dropped element	Ignores her low confidence.
C	Confusion set	Coaching fits developing competence with low commitment.
D	Inverted operation	Directing is for low competence.

12. Answer B Concept 8

Pharmacy wants all IV medications scanned at a central station for accuracy, while nursing wants bedside scanning to protect workflow. Both leaders, ~~who share an office wing~~, agree that patient safety and nurse time are critical. The go-live is three months away. Which conflict style is most appropriate?

Target word: conflict style **Decides:** Both concerns are important and there is time to find a joint solution.

A	Inverted operation	Delay wastes the time that makes collaboration possible.
B	Correct	High-stakes concerns on both sides with time available call for collaboration.
C	Adjacent category	Compromise gives up part of each important concern.
D	Confusion set	Competing fits emergencies, not shared important goals.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	4	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Kirkpatrick training evaluation levels	Level 1 reaction (did they like it), Level 2 learning (did knowledge or skill increase), Level 3 behavior (do they apply it on the job), Level 4 results (did organizational outcomes improve).	Treating a post-test score or satisfaction survey as proof of practice change.	What is measured and when: right after class vs. weeks later on the unit vs. unit outcomes.
2	Tailoring the communication plan	A communication plan matches message, channel, frequency, and sender to each audience's needs: executives get brief status on outcomes, cost, and risk; frontline staff get what changes for them and when.	Sending every stakeholder the same detailed message.	Different stakeholder groups needing updates on the same project.
3	Risk exposure and response	Risk exposure = probability × impact; address the highest exposure first with a response strategy: avoid, mitigate, transfer, or accept.	Ranking risks by impact alone or by how recently they were raised.	Risks listed with probabilities and impact ratings.
4	Diffusion of innovations	Adopter categories are innovators (about 2.5%), early adopters (13.5%), early majority (34%), late majority (34%), and laggards (16%); early adopters are respected opinion leaders and make the best champions.	Relying on innovators, whom peers may see as outliers, or trying to convert laggards first.	Choosing peer champions to spread a new practice.
5	Earned value status	EV = percent complete × budget at completion; CPI = EV / actual cost (below 1 = over budget); SPI = EV / planned value (below 1 = behind schedule).	Comparing actual cost to planned value directly, ignoring work actually done.	Budget, percent complete, planned value, and actual cost in one status report.
6	Scope change control	Any request to add or change scope goes through formal change control: document it, analyze impact on time, cost, and quality, and get sponsor approval before doing the work.	Quietly adding “small” requests to keep stakeholders happy (scope creep).	A stakeholder asking to add something mid-implementation.
7	Situational leadership	Match style to the follower's development level: directing for low competence and high commitment, coaching for some competence and low commitment, supporting for high competence and variable confidence, delegating for high competence and high commitment.	Using one style for everyone, or delegating to an enthusiastic beginner.	A staff member's skill level and confidence with a new task.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
8	Conflict management styles	Collaborating (high assertiveness, high cooperation) seeks a solution that fully meets both sides' important concerns; compromising splits the difference; accommodating yields; competing pushes one side; avoiding sidesteps.	Calling any agreement a collaboration, or compromising when both concerns are too important to give up.	Two parties with important, different concerns and time to work it out.

Course scope (public description): The Nursing Leadership and Management Field Experience course provides an opportunity for students to apply the knowledge and skills they developed in previous courses toward the successful implementation of their healthcare improvement project (HIP). This phase puts into action all the components of project management that were planned and developed while working collaboratively with key stakeholders to establish the need and feasibility of the HIP, analyzing the organizational readiness for change, and planning the implementation and evaluation phases. In this phase, students will develop and implement a training plan for staff, managers, and leaders. They will also implement the communication plan they developed in a previous course. They will also manage the implementation process by applying organizational standards and practices. Students will demonstrate strong leadership skills when meeting with stakeholders to report the status of the implementation phase and collaboratively problem-solve risks. Completion of the specialty courses is a pre-requisite for this course. This course is eligible for an In Progress grade. Please see the Grading Scale Policy for more information.